

AGRIO DYSIS IV

Summary

Agrio Dysis IV, the **Borrowed Horizon**, is a habitable refuge world near the established frontier. Its largest settled region, **the Low Plane**, is a dry basin of cattle towns and agricultural settlements dependent on wells, seasonal rivers, and rail transport.

Settlers came for land and independence, often financing their passage and the equipment needed to establish a home. Many still owe money on property their families have occupied for generations. The planet governs itself through the **Agrio Dysis Settlement Compact**, but **Erbium Industries LLC** supplies much of its infrastructure and the authenticated records on which its property laws depend.



 AGRIO DYSIS IV

The Borrowed Horizon

- Gravity** Approximately 0.94 standard gravity
- Atmosphere** Breathable but unusually dry nitrogen-oxygen atmosphere at approximately 1.03 bar
- Day** 1,722 stamp-offset minutes, divided locally into three 574-minute watches
- Year** Approximately 404,980 stamp-offset minutes, or 281.2 standard days
- Government** The **Agrio Dysis Settlement Compact**, governed through the Settlement Assembly, Watershed Council, First Commissioner, and locally chartered governments
- Capital** Highwater
- Population** Approximately 47 million; primarily human, with established communities from every major Settled Systems ancestry
- Languages** Common, Dwarven, Brenneri, Vesk, Lashunta, and numerous community languages
- Religions** Star Dream traditions, Wander memorial congregations, water-covenant practices, Vuddarian stewardship traditions, independent settlement faiths, and imported Settled Systems religions

Agrio Dysis IV has open seas, native forests, and a breathable atmosphere. Water is scarce across much of the interior, where rivers can disappear beneath gravel beds during the dry season. Towns cluster around reliable wells and transport routes. Rimlight, the planet's only major moon, illuminates the open country at night.

In the Low Plane, grazing land and irrigation channels stretch between broken mountain ranges. Rail carries most long-distance freight, supplemented by tracked carriers and low-altitude transport. Roads mainly serve the larger settlements.

Towns have grown through successive additions of prefabricated housing and locally built structures. Older buildings are patched and reinforced, often with parts from several generations of equipment. Pump stations and rail beds receive regular maintenance because the town depends on them. Erbium branding is common on leased machinery and the terminals used to administer land titles.

A DRY LIVING WORLD

Agrio Dysis IV orbits the **Agrio Dysis Primary**, a mature yellow-orange star in a system approximately 5.8 billion standard years old. The star's steady output supported a complex native biosphere long before settlement.

Property	Approximate value
Orbital distance	0.82 AU
Radius	6,435 km

Property	Approximate value
Mass	5.733 × 10 ²⁴ kg
Surface gravity	0.94 standard
Magnetic field	0.44 gauss
Atmospheric pressure	1.03 bar
Atmospheric composition	77.2% nitrogen, 21.3% oxygen, 1.1% argon; elevated but manageable carbon dioxide and little water vapor
Surface water coverage	29%

Most settlers need little physical adaptation, though the dry air makes dehydration a concern. Seas and regional lakes hold most surface water. Average mapped depths are relatively shallow, with deeper trenches and rift lakes.

Native life occupies nearly half the habitable surface. Terraforming changed regional moisture, soils, and ecosystems to support imported crops and livestock. Agrio Dysis IV was already habitable when those programs began.

THE LOW PLANE

The Low Plane lies within an ancient continental rift. Crustal extension lowered the basin between mountain blocks; volcanic deposits, sediment, and former inland seas later filled parts of it. The floor remains several hundred meters to nearly two kilometers below the surrounding uplands.

The mountains intercept coastal moisture and restrict drainage. Water enters through a few major rivers or sinks into porous sediment and fractured rock. These deposits hold extensive aquifers. Some recharge from mountain runoff; others contain ancient water that takes generations to replace.

Region	Landscape and use
North Rangegrass	Native grassland, engineered pasture, and scrub supporting much of the ranching economy.
Central Channels	Dependable rivers, irrigated farmland, and the oldest towns and railways. Productive land with high flood exposure.
Glass Salt	Dry lake basins with reflective mineral crusts. Extraction, solar collection, and specialized agriculture operate around their margins.
Southwash	Alluvial fans and shifting rivers descending from the Bluebreak Range. Floods regularly move channels and destroy boundary markers.

Region	Landscape and use
Eastern Scrub	Native vegetation and protected aquifer recharge zones. Ranching associations repeatedly petition to open land for grazing.

Much of the year is hot, with dry winds lifting dust from channels and pasture. Seasonal weather can carry western moisture over the Bluebreak Range, producing intense storms over narrow parts of the basin. A town may receive little rain for years, followed by a season's rainfall within a few hundred minutes.

REGIONS BEYOND THE LOW PLANE

THE BLUEBREAK RANGE

The **Bluebreak Range** borders the basin to the west. Its wetter slopes contain forests, farms, and reservoirs feeding several major rivers. Upland towns depend on forestry, orchard agriculture, and the construction and maintenance of water infrastructure.

Watershed compacts divide claims to the headwaters among local communities, downstream governments, and agricultural operators. Ownership of streamside land does not necessarily include control of the water. Bluebreak residents resent basin demands for a larger share.

THE SABLE COAST

The **Sable Coast** borders a large inland sea west of the mountains. Its cooler, wetter climate supports forests, wetlands, and coastal agriculture. Fishing and port towns occupy the settled shore, with ecological reserves protecting native habitats and migration routes.

The coast exports food, timber, manufactured goods, and biological products used in medicine and water treatment. Residents resent being treated as a source of water and tax revenue for the basin, and object to outsiders calling the entire planet the Low Plane.

THE ASHSTEP TABLELANDS

East of the basin, the **Ashstep Tablelands** contain volcanic plateaus with small mining and farming settlements, solar facilities, and isolated observatories and religious communities. Aquifers are limited, but seasonal rain is more predictable. Communal cisterns and catchment fields support towns with strict residency rules.

Several communities shelter settlers whose Low Plane charters were revoked. Central authorities regard these arrivals as an unauthorized transfer of settlement liability.

TIME ON AGRIO DYSIS IV

Local measure	Duration
Day	1,722 stamp-offset minutes; 28.7 standard hours
Watch	574 stamp-offset minutes; three per local day
Year	Approximately 404,980 stamp-offset minutes; 281.2 standard days or 235 local days
Rimturn	Rimlight's orbital and rotational cycle: approximately 32,042 stamp-offset minutes, or 534 standard hours

Civil schedules use watches. First watch generally includes the coolest daylight hours, second watch the greatest heat, and third watch evening and night work. The relationship to sunrise varies by season and latitude. Households stagger sleep, and large towns operate through overlapping shifts.

Regional calendars follow agricultural and ecological seasons. Low Plane residents track dry periods, river rises, and grazing recovery; coastal calendars follow rainfall and fisheries. Rimturns help schedule night travel, markets, and religious observances, as well as informing local predictions of tides and animal behavior.

Legal records use **Post-Erbium Standard**. The campaign begins at **29:08472119 PES** . One standard lapse spans approximately 41.4 local years. Families may describe their history in floods and dry seasons, while their legal obligations are recorded in lapses and raw stamps.

SURVEY AND EARLY SETTLEMENT

Pre-PES surveys found a living world suitable for imported agriculture, with serious regional water shortages and poorly understood ecological risks. Settlement remained limited during the war with Zakaron because the system lay away from the main war routes and lacked immediately strategic resources.

Period	Development
0:00000000 PES	Following the Still-Drive Accords, Agrio Dysis IV entered the Settled Systems registry as a protected survey and agricultural-development world.
Lapse 2	Permanent research stations began studying the climate and the interaction of native ecosystems with imported agriculture.
Lapse 5	Erbium and public governments authorized limited terraforming trials. Some agricultural and moisture-management projects succeeded; others spread beyond their boundaries or damaged native ecosystems.

Period	Development
Lapse 8	Housing pressure and unemployment on older worlds, especially Theosis , prompted the Open Horizon Settlement Initiative .
Lapses 9–10	Major Low Plane settlements formed. Crosswind Junction began as a rail and well camp, followed by Charter House Six.
Lapse 12	Engineered cattle and other grazing animals entered widespread use.
Lapses 13–14	Rail expansion connected cattle towns to upland water supplies and offworld freight routes.
Lapse 16	The Agrio Dysis Settlement Compact established a common planetary government.
Lapse 22	Prolonged dry conditions led to the formation of the Longwater Cooperative .

Open Horizon offered passage, a settlement charter, and the supplies needed to establish a household or agricultural operation. Applicants could earn full title through continuous occupation and improvements. Passage and equipment were financed with deferred payments.

The program attracted displaced and unemployed people alongside families and religious communities seeking independence. Local government developed through overlapping town councils, water boards, and charter organizations. The Compact was formed to settle their competing jurisdictions and administer shared services.

THE AGRIO DYSIS SETTLEMENT COMPACT

The **Agrio Dysis Settlement Compact** is legally independent of Erbium. Its founding charter gives it authority over civil law, public services, environmental and water regulation, taxation, and planetary representation. Much of the equipment and information needed to exercise that authority comes from corporate suppliers.

THE SETTLEMENT ASSEMBLY

The **Settlement Assembly** represents incorporated towns, charter districts, and recognized population centers. Seats follow registered population, with minimum representation for small incorporated communities. Independent homesteads vote through charter districts whose offices may be hundreds of kilometers away.

The Assembly controls civil legislation, the general budget, public services, transport policy, and planetary taxes. It can investigate corporations and revoke local operating licenses, though essential services may have no alternative supplier.

THE WATERSHED COUNCIL

The **Watershed Council** represents drainage basins, aquifer districts, coastal authorities, recognized cooperatives, and protected ecological regions. Its representation accounts for the importance of a water source as well as the population living beside it.

The Council can delay or reject legislation affecting water management, terraforming, environmental protection, or ownership of watershed infrastructure. Critics argue that this gives large landholders and water authorities disproportionate influence. Supporters point to the millions of downstream residents dependent on sparsely populated headwaters and recharge zones.

THE FIRST COMMISSIONER

The **First Commissioner** is nominated by the Assembly, confirmed by the Watershed Council, and approved in a planetary vote. The office administers public agencies, appoints senior officials, and negotiates intersystem agreements.

Commissioners have broad powers during environmental, transport, and public-health emergencies, subject to legislative, judicial, and municipal limits. Their work regularly requires negotiations with Erbium over infrastructure and its financing.

THE CHARTER COURT

The **Charter Court** is the highest civil and administrative court. It hears disputes over property, settlement obligations, municipal authority, and environmental restrictions, including challenges to corporate registry evidence.

Judges receive long appointments through a joint legislative process. Some trained in Erbium's legal and finance offices, which provide much of the available professional education. The court can reject corporate evidence, but often lacks an alternative record recognized by intersystem authorities.

THE OFFICE OF SURVEY AND RECORD

The public **Office of Survey and Record** maintains planetary maps and records of property, occupancy, and flood damage. It reviews and republishes data supplied by Charter House Six and associated registries, sometimes challenging their findings.

Using corporate surveys saves the cost of a complete independent network. It also leaves much of the evidence used in public property law under private control.

THE PLANETARY WATER BUREAU

The **Planetary Water Bureau** manages major reservoirs and pipelines, municipal allocations, and emergency transfers. It also sets minimum ecological flows and maintains aquifer models.

Its engineers coordinate infrastructure beyond any single town's capacity. Their models combine government and local observations with corporate surveys and extraction reports. Some data arrive late or incomplete, and some suppliers have financial interests in the resulting allocations.

AGRIO DYSIS IV AND THEOSIS

Agrio Dysis IV sends five delegates to the **Council of Settled Systems Administration** at Concordance Hall on Theosis. The Assembly and Watershed Council each select two; the First Commissioner selects one. Differences over property, labor, and environmental policy often divide the delegation.

Erbium's separate Infrastructure Stewardship Seat gives it a permanent vote on many of the same questions. Agrio delegates object to the company's combined corporate, infrastructural, and governmental influence. Erbium maintains that its seat represents technical responsibilities shared across the systems, distinct from the delegation's responsibility to residents.

ERBIUM WITHOUT A FLAG

Erbium's influence rests on settlement finance, agricultural licensing, transport, and authenticated records. Its holdings include Charter House Six, survey infrastructure, parts of the freight and communications networks, and the registry software used by the Transfer Spindle. Public projects also depend on corporate insurance and financing.

The Compact can regulate subsidiaries, fund public alternatives, and support cooperatives. Replacement systems are expensive, especially where existing machinery or livestock requires licensed parts and treatments. Public agencies also need records that courts and offworld institutions will recognize.

LAND, CHARTERS, AND OWNERSHIP

Several separate interests can apply to the same property.

Interest	What it establishes
Physical occupation	Where someone actually lives or works.
Stamped title	Legally recognized ownership.
Settlement charter	Conditional occupation and improvement rights, usually before full title is earned.

Interest	What it establishes
Grazing rights	Permission to use land for livestock without owning it.
Water rights	Access to a specified source or supply.
Improvement obligations	Required development, maintenance, or productive use within a set period.
Communal use	Shared access through a local institution or recognized custom.
Equipment liens	A creditor's claim over financed property.
Emergency refuge rights	Temporary occupation during a disaster or infrastructure failure.

AUTHENTICATED RECORDS

Code **A1%1&17-4**, the **Authenticated Cadastral Record Priority Provision**, gives recognized survey and title records a rebuttable presumption of accuracy when local evidence has been lost. It provides continuity after disasters, but makes Charter House Six's records difficult to challenge.

Local records, witnesses, and evidence of occupation can rebut a corporate survey. A successful challenge usually requires legal assistance and time for a court to examine the evidence.

BENEFICIAL OCCUPATION

Code **A7%9&6-8**, the **Beneficial Settlement Occupancy Requirement**, permits authorities to reclaim chartered land when a holder fails to meet requirements for verified residence, productive use, stewardship, or improvements.

The rule prevents speculative claims from keeping usable land empty. It can also penalize families whose work or occupation was interrupted by illness, environmental damage, or an evacuation.

FLOOD REASSESSMENT

Code **A7%9&14-6**, the **Post-Inundation Parcel Reconciliation Provision**, authorizes reassessment when flooding makes an existing boundary description unusable. The Office of Survey and Record conducts the process using substantial amounts of Charter House Six imagery and elevation data.

Reassessment updates titles to match altered rivers and terrain. It can also divide an occupied property or transfer access to a valuable crossing, particularly when one party's survey is accepted before competing evidence arrives.

CHARTER HOUSE SIX

Erbium Charter House Six stands on a reinforced rise near the central rail corridor. It handles authenticated property and water records, settlement finance, and transport certification. Residents use it to register or dispute claims and clear obligations attached to their property.

The complex has independent power and a protected archive behind composite walls and flood barriers higher than those of nearby neighborhoods. Its records have survived disasters that destroyed local documents and survey markers. Their reliability and recognition by offworld institutions give them substantial authority in public proceedings.

After floods, the House generates provisional boundaries from archived records, satellite imagery, and hydrological models. These assessments may conflict with generations of local occupation.

WATER RIGHTS

Ownership of a water source, permission to extract from it, and control of the equipment carrying it are separate interests. Access can also be limited by pipeline easements, ecological requirements, and emergency requisitions. Owning land or holding grazing rights does not automatically authorize groundwater extraction.

Disputes therefore depend on technical evidence and the terms of several overlapping agreements. A valid water claim may be unusable if its holder can no longer afford the pump.

AQUIFER STEWARDSHIP

Code **A7%6&11-3**, the **Confined Aquifer Withdrawal and Subsidence Monitoring Standard**, requires high-volume operators to report extraction and its effects on aquifer pressure, recharge, surrounding ground, and downstream users.

The Water Bureau uses these reports to allocate water and can suspend dangerous extraction. Large operators can afford compliant sensors and legal staff; smaller communities often cannot, leaving their observations with less administrative weight. Suspending an operator may also interrupt supplies to communities without another source.

LONGWATER COOPERATIVE

The **Longwater Cooperative** connects settlements and water districts through shared infrastructure, repair crews, and emergency reserves. It formed during the Lapse 22 drought after government assistance failed to meet several small communities' needs.

Members contribute labor, materials, or funds according to their means. They frequently disagree over how that support should be distributed. Upstream communities cite maintenance costs, downstream towns face greater flood exposure, and ranches compete with drinking reserves for dry-season supplies. Some religious members restrict the commercial uses their contributions can support.

Longwater's repair work has earned local trust. Its lack of a single authoritative charter weakens its position in disputes with governments and corporations.

DROUGHT, PUMPING, AND FLOOD

Heavy extraction reduces pressure in confined aquifers. Sediment compacts as water is removed, causing subsidence that lowers districts relative to rivers and alters drainage. Pumping also dries wetlands and native plant communities that slow runoff.

When storms arrive, degraded soil absorbs less water. Runoff collects in subsided areas, sometimes behind levees built for earlier ground levels. Reservoir operators may have to release stored water if a storm threatens capacity, adding to downstream flooding.

Longwater's records attribute worsening shortages and redirected floodwater to upstream corporate extraction. The Water Bureau accepts that pumping contributes to subsidence but disputes Longwater's estimate of its impact. It argues that immediate suspension would interrupt water supplies for more people than it would protect.

EMERGENCY WATER AUTHORITY

Code **A9%8&7-9**, the **Emergency Water and Conveyance Requisition Provision**, allows recognized governments to temporarily direct privately controlled water supplies and transport during declared environmental or public-health emergencies.

Owners are entitled to compensation, based on authenticated records of use and any existing public obligations. Small operators often wait longer for payment than corporate providers. Maintaining an independent supply can make a community an early target for requisition.

SETTLEMENT DEBT

Settler households commonly hold separate contracts for passage, land, equipment, and agricultural stock. Satisfying a charter does not clear the other debts, which can exceed the property's sale value.

Code **A4%1&15-2**, the **Independent Charter Operator Classification**, generally excludes settlers from employee status when they control their own production and commercial decisions. Independent businesses can operate without becoming departments of their financiers or buyers.

The classification also limits claims to wages, employment protections, and benefits. This affects settlers whose contracts dictate their equipment, production standards, and approved customers despite their nominal independence.

LEAVING THE PLANET

Debt alone does not prohibit departure. The **Low Plane Transfer Spindle** screens passengers for warrants and transport restrictions, then checks whether accompanying property is cleared to leave.

Code **A5%8&12-5**, the **Encumbered Equipment Transport Verification Provision**, requires carriers and ports to verify permission before financed or leased property leaves the jurisdiction where its lien can be enforced. It covers livestock and equipment, including medical devices and implants.

A family may be free to leave while unable to take the property it needs to live or work elsewhere. Departing without the required authorization on a private or off-stamp vessel can lead to theft charges, invalidated identity records, and difficulty returning lawfully.

ECOLOGY AND TERRAFORMING

Native life developed around seasonal water shortages. Deep-rooted plants and fungal networks retain water and move nutrients through dry soil. Burrowing animals create infiltration channels, while native grazers migrate between water sources.

Imported agricultural species and biological controls have become established beyond the areas where they were introduced. Engineered pasture recovers quickly after grazing, but its shallow roots retain less soil and water than many native plants. Heat-tolerant livestock can digest local and imported feed, yet concentrated herds erode banks and compact ground around wells.

Terraforming microbes improve some soils while disrupting native fungal systems. Moisture management can increase rain in one district at the expense of another. Environmental policy now concentrates on keeping these altered ecosystems functional.

BRAIDROOT

Braidroot forms low mats above dense roots extending many meters into dry floodplains and recharge zones. Its channels allow rain to penetrate compacted ground, stabilizing sediment and helping replenish aquifers.

Mature braidroot is poor forage and tangles agricultural cutters. Clearing it creates more pasture but increases erosion and runoff. Protected braidroot corridors have become a recurring dispute between environmental authorities and landholders.

NATIVE AND ENGINEERED ANIMALS

Native dryland grazers are generally low-bodied, multi-limbed animals suited to uneven ground and sparse vegetation. Some native predators now hunt imported stock. Ranchers may defend their herds, subject to restrictions near preserves.

Engineered livestock includes cattle and specialized herd animals for steep or scrubby terrain. Many lines remain under corporate genetic licenses. Independent breeders develop local stock able to survive without licensed feed; corporate veterinary authorities classify some of those lines as biologically unverified.

DISEASE AND QUARANTINE

Native and imported species continue to exchange infections. Disease can persist in wild populations, and local soil organisms sometimes change the effectiveness of agricultural and veterinary treatments.

The Transfer Spindle screens incoming people, animals, and biological cargo, including potentially contaminated equipment. Surface veterinary offices establish checkpoints during outbreaks. Quarantine protects ecosystems and food supplies but can bankrupt ranches unable to move, sell, or slaughter their animals during an investigation.

RANCHING AND THE CATTLE TOWNS

Ranching supports a large processing and service economy. Most cattle-town residents work in transport, maintenance, commerce, or public services. Herd movements shape town schedules: drives close crossings, quarantine delays sales, and water allocations limit the number of animals a district can support.

Ranch owners hold political influence through their land and export income, despite being outnumbered by the workers and residents supporting those operations.

CLOTHING OF THE LOW PLANE

Low Plane workwear protects against heat, glare, dust, and sudden rain. The familiar hat has a tall creased crown for ventilation and a wide curved brim. Replaceable bands identify community or occupational affiliations; travelers sometimes reverse them to hide an association likely to cause trouble.

Dust coats, ventilated shirts, and reinforced boots are standard travel clothing, with water carriers and respiratory protection close at hand. Materials and protective equipment vary by trade. Officials often wear cleaner versions of local workwear to emphasize their connection to the region.

LOCAL CULTURE

Reputation depends heavily on practical competence and willingness to help during an emergency. Residents remember who turned up to repair shared infrastructure and who avoided the work.

Hosts traditionally offer **first water** before serious conversation with a traveler. Even a small amount promises that the guest will not go thirsty under their roof. Refusal can express distrust or unwillingness to accept an obligation.

Settlements keep **ground books**, physical and locally copied records of community life, property use, and witnessed agreements. They remain available during relay outages and can supplement authenticated evidence in court. Charter House Six accepts them in that role, although they do not automatically override registry records.

Flood marks on buildings and public infrastructure record earlier high-water levels, helping residents judge an approaching storm.

Mutual aid carries obligations. Communities record emergency assistance and expect recipients to contribute in return, sometimes for years. Membership rules and old disputes can exclude people from otherwise generous local support. Religious settlements may provide refuge under strict rules, while cooperatives reserve water for contributing households.

Residents often distrust contract enforcement and collection officials. They still expect public intervention when flooding, disease, or upstream extraction exceeds a town's ability to respond.

HUMANS AND OTHER SETTLERS

Humans form the largest population group. Relocation programs supplied human-standard housing and equipment, making human settlement comparatively cheap and directing many struggling households toward the frontier.

Local standing depends on reputation, practical skill, land, and water access. Established families pass property and political connections to their children, preserving substantial class differences despite hostility toward Theosis corporate hierarchies.

Other ancestries live throughout the planet. Some communities have developed particular institutions and concerns:

Comm unity	Local presence
Dwarves	Rail and heavy-repair businesses, including independent clan workshops. Some clanholdings preserve records for neighboring towns.
Brenneri	Water management, medicine, and cooperative organization. Protected aquatic neighborhoods near reservoirs help meet the costs of living on a dry world.
Fonquons	Environmental planning and settlement administration. Their communities have challenged simplified corporate water models.
Lashuntas	Work across public and agricultural life; telepathy assists storm response and crowded livestock operations.
Vesk	Prominent in ranching, freight, and heavy repair, with some established families becoming major landholders.
Madrosarai	Medical and technical firms providing cybernetics, bloodline services, veterinary research, and specialized security.
Moyishuu	Visiting constellations frequent orbital and survey facilities. Surface residents often work in aviation, observation, archives, or courier services.
Androids	Live and work throughout the settlements. Distance reduces direct corporate oversight but makes replacement parts and authorized maintenance harder to obtain.
Astrazons	Established across towns and transport networks. Ground books sometimes preserve identities and relationships poorly represented by standard records.

RIMLIGHT

Rimlight, Agrio Dysis IV's only major moon, has a radius of approximately 1,100 km and a mass of 1.79×10^{22} kg. Its composition is about 58% rock and 42% water ice. It is tidally locked, with only a negligible oxygen exosphere.

Surface and buried ice support scientific stations, limited extraction, and orbital reserves. Its cycle of approximately 32,042 stamp-offset minutes anchors the rimturn calendar. Moonlight assists night travel; residents have long used its position in predictions of tides, river conditions, and seasonal activity.

STORM-EYE OBSERVATORY

Storm-Eye Observatory is a small government facility on Rimlight that monitors planetary weather and water conditions. Its broad view often identifies developing flood threats before surface stations can confirm them, giving towns time to evacuate, move livestock, and prepare reservoirs.

Public forecasts pass through the Water Bureau. When observations conflict with official allocation models, release may be delayed while analysts reconcile them. Officials cite the risks of contradictory evacuation and reservoir instructions. Observatory staff argue that these delays leave settlements without adequate warning.

THE LOW PLANE TRANSFER SPINDLE

The **Low Plane Transfer Spindle** handles orbital passenger and cargo transfers. A central docking spine connects to rotating habitation and cargo sections. Approximately 188 crew live aboard permanently, with capacity for around 260 during ordinary operations.

Its principal facilities are the **Livestock Transfer Ring**, **Surface Freight Sling**, **Charter Registry Uplink**, **Passenger Quarantine Deck**, and **Water-Ice Reserve**, supported by workshops, inspection bays, and temporary housing.

The Compact administers the station. Erbium supplies and audits its registry systems. Public authorities authorize passenger travel; corporate records establish whether accompanying property is cleared for transport under the equipment-lien rules.

THE AGRIO DYSIS SYSTEM

AGRIO DYSIS I

Agrio Dysis I is a small, tidally locked, airless world. The automated **Cauter Leases** extract dense metals from the permanent dayside. Human crews service the shielded mines during tightly controlled shutdowns.

Erbium offers projected mine revenue as collateral in infrastructure financing for Agrio Dysis IV. The Compact's borrowing consequently depends on resources it does not own, extracted at facilities where its citizens perform dangerous maintenance.

AGRIO DYSIS II

Agrio Dysis II is a hot greenhouse world with a dense carbon-dioxide and sulfur atmosphere. Robotic **Brass Weather Platforms** collect sulfur compounds and industrial feedstock in its upper atmosphere. Crewed missions are brief; drones and replacement platforms handle most maintenance.

AGRIO DYSIS III

Agrio Dysis III is a hot, thin-aired desert world used for solar collection, extraction, and freight staging. **Dryline Yard** holds equipment bound for Agrio Dysis IV and the main belt. Its sealed warehouses are an important emergency supply point, though much of the published reserve is pledged against unrelated corporate obligations.

THE MAIN BELT AND OUTER SYSTEM

Corporate claims, independent prospectors, and settlement cooperatives work the rocky and carbonaceous bodies of the **Agrio Dysis Main Belt**.

The ringed gas giant **Agrio Dysis V** supports fuel harvesting and outer-system traffic. Its icy moon **Longwatch** houses the buried **Cold Pump Depot**, producing water, oxygen, and propellant feedstock.

The distant ice giant **Agrio Dysis VI** marks the practical limit of routine traffic. Activity there is mainly automated survey work.

MAJOR LOCATIONS

HIGHWATER

Highwater, the capital, occupies a reinforced upland shelf above the northern basin. Major railways and mountain-fed pipelines serve its civic district, which houses the Compact's central institutions.

The site is protected from ordinary floods and better supplied than most basin towns. Residents consider that stability necessary for government; downstream communities resent the capital's priority water allocation.

CROSSWIND JUNCTION

Crosswind Junction is a major cattle town and the basin's principal interior freight center. It grew around a well, rail camp, and seasonal river crossing. Repeated floods forced sections of railway to move and the central district to be raised.

Herds from the North Rangelass spend several watches in its yards for inspection, sale, and transfer. The deep well supplies both the town and surrounding settlements. Every expansion renews disputes over dry-season priority.

LONGWATER COOPERATIVE

Longwater's administrative and repair center occupies a converted rail complex southwest of Crosswind Junction. Its warehouses hold shared maintenance supplies and emergency water equipment. Dispatchers keep both stamped records and ground books, using local communications and couriers during relay failures.

Members disagree about releasing evidence against upstream corporate pumping. Some want public disclosure; others fear litigation will disrupt essential equipment contracts.

ERBIUM CHARTER HOUSE SIX

Charter House Six is the basin's central authenticated registry. Many of its employees are local residents who see reliable records as protection against powerful families taking land by force. Its procedures nevertheless favor Erbium-controlled data over other evidence.

BLUEBREAK

Bluebreak is the largest mountain settlement and a center for reservoirs, hydropower, and pipeline maintenance. Its engineers negotiate deliveries with basin and coastal authorities, Longwater, and corporate agricultural operators.

Residents regard water as a product of local land and labor. Basin officials argue that communities nearest the headwaters cannot control supplies needed across the planet.

SABLE PORT

Sable Port, the coast's largest city, supports fishing, coastal agriculture, and associated processing and maintenance industries. It also produces native biological treatments. Goods can reach orbital launch facilities through the port without using the main Low Plane rail network.

Its delegates oppose cattle-town political dominance and proposals for increased coastal water transfers inland.

DEEPREED PRESERVE

Deepeed Preserve protects eastern aquifer recharge zones, including braidroot plains, seasonal wetlands, and migration corridors. Research and ranger stations monitor the area, with limited routes open to visitors.

Scientists argue that protecting the vegetation sustains the basin's water supply. Neighboring ranchers want access to more grazing land.

RED SPUR WORKS

Red Spur Works, on the southeastern basin edge, grew around a public rail yard and independent dwarven workshops. It repairs heavy transport, agricultural machinery, and flood-damaged infrastructure.

Local unions support manufacturing to reduce reliance on imported Erbium parts. Licensed control systems and specialized materials still limit what they can produce independently.

MORROW STOCK INSTITUTE

The **Morrow Stock Institute** is a publicly funded veterinary, agricultural, and quarantine center outside Crosswind Junction. It studies engineered herds and their interaction with native life, with additional funding from corporate research grants.

Its scientists disagree over whether a new illness began in imported stock, native animals, or a licensed veterinary treatment.

COVENANT WELLS

Covenant Wells is an Ashstep religious municipality with communal water, shared labor, and strict internal discipline. It shelters families who have lost charters, equipment, or records. Residents accept limits on private property while receiving community protection.

The Compact recognizes the settlement as lawful. Charter House Six disputes its right to shelter residents whose obligations remain attached to another district.